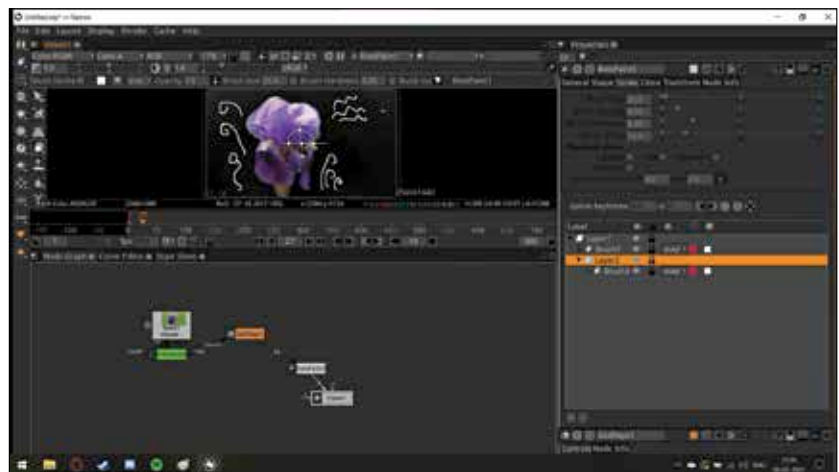
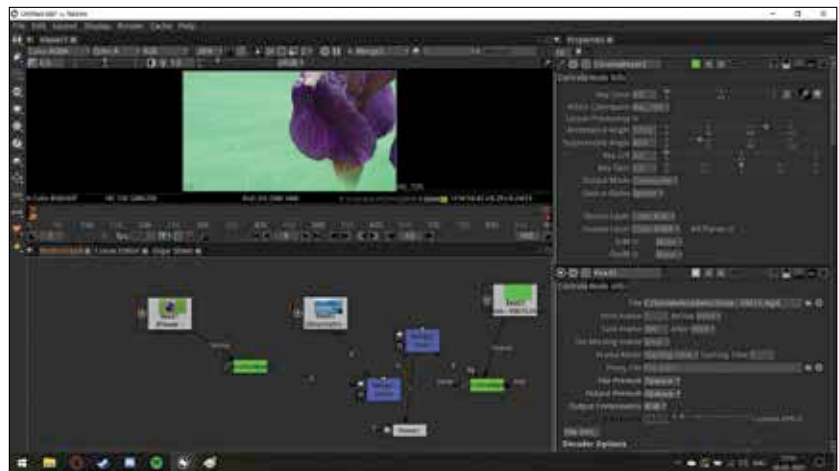


ering over it gives a quick tip. Select the green from the screen to be removed. Now we have to set up the pipeline. Read1 is routed to ChromaKeyer and then to Merge1, while Read2 is directly connected to Merge1. Merge1 is then connected to Read1. We have now eliminated the background from the foreground video. Now, you can additionally process either of the two videos, add distortions, filters or other effects.

WORKING WITH NODES

The main thing about Natron is working with the nodes. In the example shown here, a more complicated pipeline has been setup. Where there are two layers of chroma keyed videos, and two video sources have colour correction applied to them, with one of the video sources having an additional Equalizer node. First, two videos are merged into a single video using one Merge node, and then the second video is merged with the first two combined in the second Merge node. Some of the important and useful nodes are Crop and Resize, both of which are helpful during chromakeying. If there are portions of the video that you do not want to retain at all then the CornerPin and CornerPin mask nodes essentially work as a garbage matte, allowing you to retain or delete the covered parts of a video. There are some interesting and fun nodes to try out, such as God Rays, which lets you stretch and distort the image along multiple axes. Then there are a whole bunch of deformations, degradations and frames that act as a proxy for particle effects and advanced 3D rendering, such as adding liquid ripples, smoke clouds, snow and adding various types of textures and patterns on the video.



ROTOSCOPING

Rotoscoping is the process of drawing or painting directly onto frames of the video, which are great for creating animatics. One of the most famous and well known examples of special effects produced by rotoscoping, are the lightsabres in the Star Wars Franchise. Natron has two nodes meant for rotoscoping, Roto and RotoPaint. Out of these two, RotoPaint is more useful as it allows you to paint directly onto the frames of the video. Note that the additional painted layers are displayed for that frame only, so if you want to animate moving lines or

images across multiple frames, then you have to add and move these individually. Natron provides plenty of flexibility when it comes to the build up of layers, as for every frame you can add and paint on an arbitrary number of layers. The frames with stuff painted on them are indicated by small green dots, which makes it easy for editors to scrub to the frames they need to work on. The basic pipeline for rotoscoping on Natron is a Reader node for the video, the RotoPaint node which contains all the layers of images for all the frames, and the Viewer node for rendering the final output. **1**

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